

WATER COLOR
RENDERINGS
OF VENICE
By
PIERRE VIGNAL



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Illustrator: Pierre Vignal

Author of introduction, etc.: William Robert Powell

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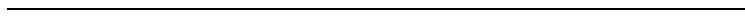
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Introduction By
WILLIAM ROBERT POWELL

J. H. JANSEN, PUBLISHER
CLEVELAND, O.
1925

LIST OF PLATES

Ponte del Paradise

A Rio

Colleone

The Rialto

The Piazzetta

Piazza San Marco

The Clock Tower

Entrance to the Palace

A Street

San Marco, A Doorway

Entrance to the Ducal Palace

Canal of the Church of The Madonna de Miracoli

San Rocco

San Giorgio from the Giudecca

Riva Degli Schiavoni

*Cover and Tide Page Designed by
C. L. Aiken*

PIERRE VIGNAL AND HIS TECHNIQUE



1855-1925

THE WATER COLORS of Pierre Vignal rank as the foremost in contemporary French art. He uses water color in its true sense of being a transparent and not an opaque medium. There is no chinese white on his palette.

Each operation in producing a picture is final. No washes are gone over a second time. In this way he attains the maximum of transparency and his pictures are free from spots or muddy and opaque blotches of color.

The drawing of a subject is carefully done with a soft pencil and in a fine light line, so that it will not show in the picture after the color is applied. Drawing is as important in his work as color and value.

Pierre Vignal has so well mastered his art that he can visualize the finished picture, both as to color and value, before he applies any color.

His work is based on the principle that the subject should be simple, treated in a broad way and free from much detail. The reproductions in this portfolio are nearly the exact size of the original pictures, his theory being that a water color should be small, as the medium does not permit the covering of as large a surface as oil. The interest must be confined to a central point with usually one predominant dark and light value, each being in sharp contrast.

In making his pictures, M. Vignal first applies the sky, which is as important in value as in color. Thus the picture is started at the top of the paper and finished at the bottom, as the next operation consists in putting in the dominant shadows, which are usually done in one operation, and finally the highlights and darker values on the shadows. When the sky and shadows are completed the main values of the picture are established, and the highlights being thin and transparent do not change the other values.

Most of the color is mixed on the paper as the work progresses and not on the palette, thus a pleasing transparent change and variety of color is obtained which can be seen by a study of the shadows and highlights in the plates.

Some of the color is applied rather dry, some of it very wet and again the surface of the paper is moistened and the color is put on and allowed to spread through this moist surface to produce varied effects and contrasts. To quote from Leopold Honore in the *Journal des Artistes*:

“Whether his water colors are of Italy, The Villa D’Este, Granada, Morocco, Nimes, Avignon or Paris, they are always out-of-doors, full of truth, light and sunshine and real fascination of color. One feels and sees that everything is painted with masterly skill, without a discordant note. Everything is in a vibrating note, but always remaining harmonious.”

(Original Preface)

WILLIAM ROBERT POWELL
Former Pupil of Pierre Vignal

PORTFOLIOS OF WATER COLOR
RENDERINGS BY PIERRE VIGNAL

Venice (Out of Print)
Gardens of Rome
Northern Italian Cities
Palestine
Naples



VENICE—PONTE DEL PARADISO



VENICE—A RIO



VENICE—VEROCCHIO BARTOLOMEO COLLEONI



VENICE—THE RIALTO



Vignas

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VENICE—THE PIAZZETTA



VENICE—PIAZZA SAN MARCO



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Vignoli

VENICE—THE CLOCK TOWER



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UNIV. OF
ORIGINAL FROM
UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA

VENICE—ENTRANCE TO THE PALACE



VENICE—A STREET



VENICE—SAN MARCO A DOORWAY



Vignola

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UNIVERSITY

VENICE—ENTRANCE TO THE DUCAL PALACE



VENICE—CANAL OF THE CHURCH OF THE MADONNA DEI MIRACOLI



VENICE—SAN ROCCO



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Vignal

VENICE—SAN GIORGIO FROM THE GIUDECCA



VENICE—RIVA DEGLI SCHIAVONI

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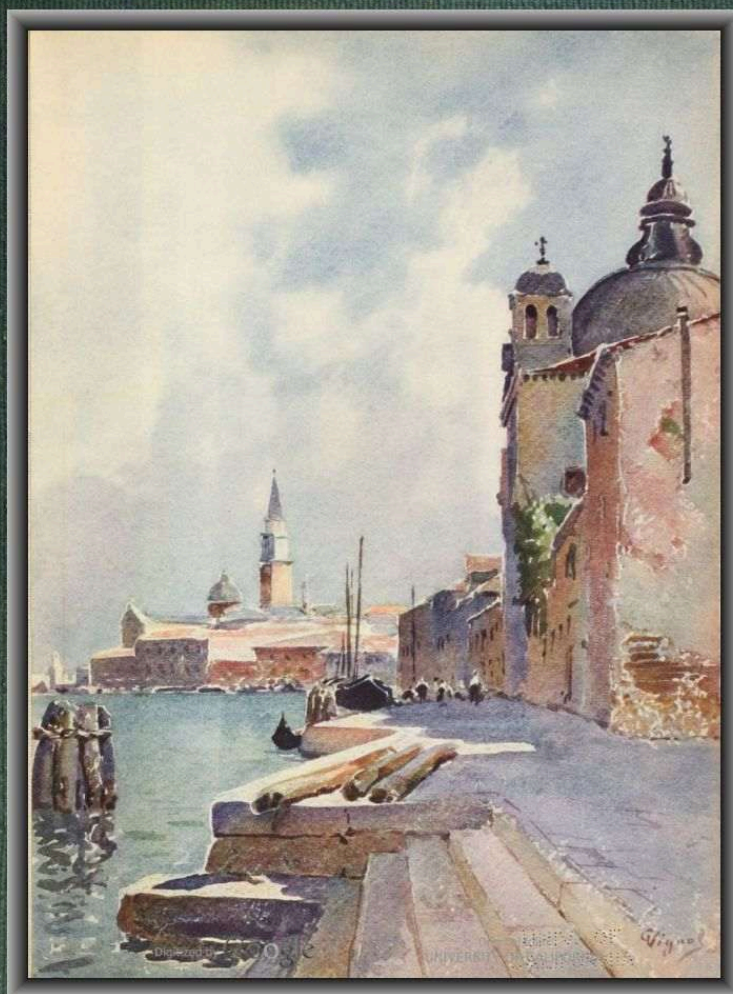
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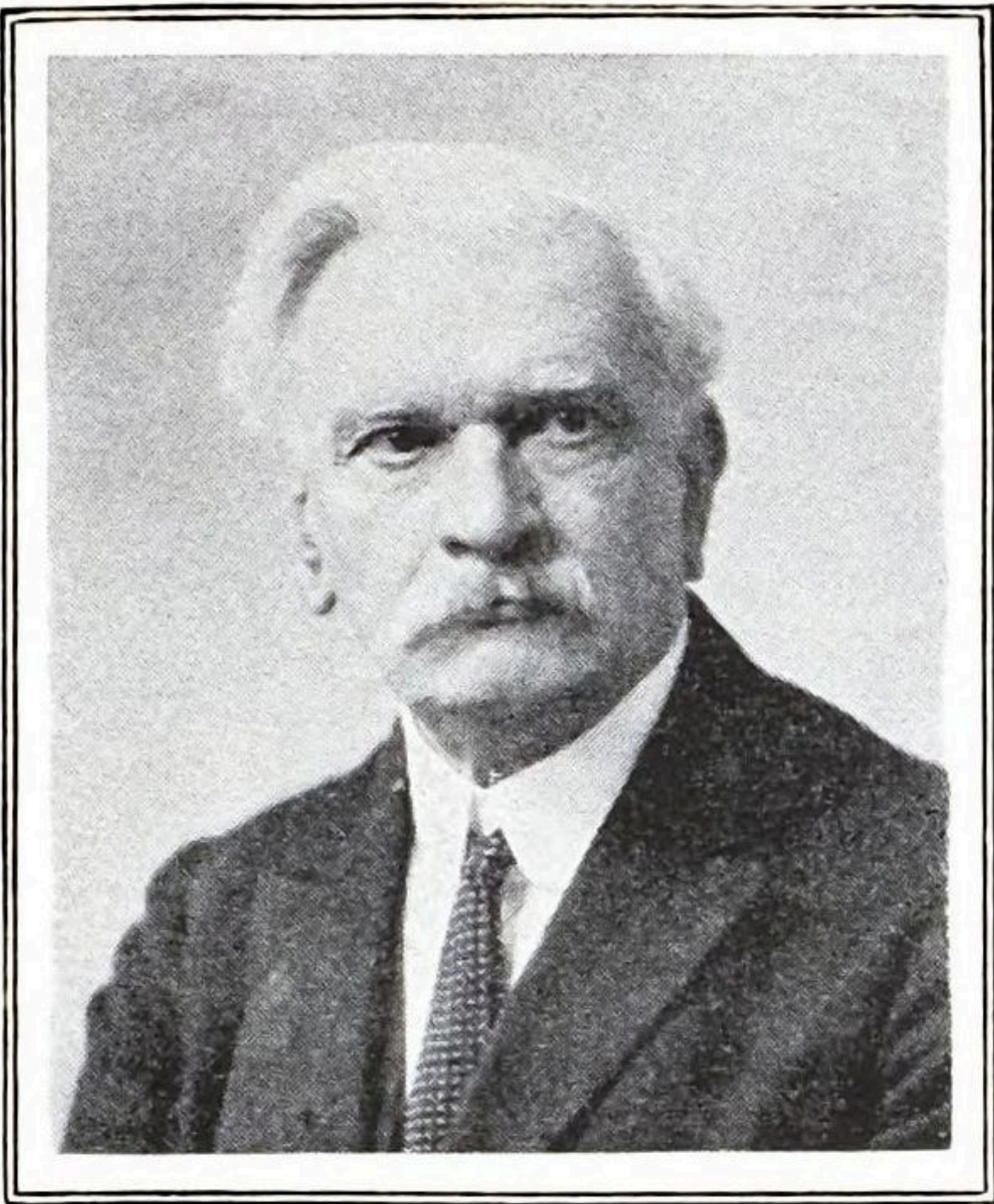
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